

The Fetter of Craving

Taṇhāsaṃyojana Sutta (Iti 15)

Vuttañhetam bhagavatā vuttamarahatāti me sutam:

“Nāham, bhikkhave, aññaṃ ekasaṃyojanampi samanupassāmi yena saṃyojanena saṃyuttā sattā dīgharattaṃ sandhāvanti saṃsaranti yathayidaṃ, bhikkhave, taṇhāsaṃyojanam. Taṇhāsaṃyojanena hi, bhikkhave, saṃyuttā sattā dīgharattaṃ sandhāvanti saṃsaranti”ti.

This was said by the Blessed One, said by the Arahant, as I have heard:

"Monks, I do not see any other single fetter by which beings are bound, running and wandering in saṃsāra for such a long time, like the fetter of craving. Indeed, bound by the fetter of craving, monks, beings run and wander in saṃsāra for a long time."

Etamattham bhagavā avoca. Tatthetam iti vuccati:

The Blessed One said this. In this connection, this was said:

“Taṇhādutiyo puriso, dīghamaddhāna saṃsaram; Itthabhāvaññathābhāvaṃ, saṃsāram nātivattati.

"A person with craving as their companion, wanders for a long time in saṃsāra; they do not transcend the cycle of becoming— from this state to another.

Etamādīnavam ñatvā, Taṇham dukkhassa sambhavam; Vītataṇho anādāno, Sato bhikkhu paribbaje”ti.

Knowing this danger, that craving is the origin of suffering, free from craving, without clinging, a bhikkhu should wander mindfully."

Ayampi attho vutto bhagavatā, iti me sutanti.

Pañcamam.

This matter too was spoken by the Blessed One, as I have heard.

(Fifth)

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
taṇhā	taṇhā	craving	Fetter of Craving	The mental reaction of thirst or desire that arises in response to bodily sensations, binding beings to suffering.
saṃyojana	saṃyojana	fetter; bond	Fetter of Craving	The mental chains that bind beings to the wheel of rebirth (<i>saṃsāra</i>), craving being the primary fetter.
saṃsāra	saṃsāra	cycle of rebirth; wandering	Fetter of Craving	The perpetual round of birth, death, and rebirth across different planes of existence driven by conditioning.
bhikkhu	bhikkhu	monk; spiritual seeker	Fetter of Craving	In the universal sense, any practitioner who is walking the path of Dhamma with mindfulness.

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
sambhavā	sambhavā	origin; source	Fetter of Craving	The source or arising, here referring to craving as the source/origin of suffering (<i>dukkha</i>).
anādāna	anādāna	without clinging; unattached	Fetter of Craving	The state of being free from the habit of grasping or holding onto experiences, mental states, or objects.

Translator Notes

1. **Opening Formula (*Vuttañhetam...*):** This is the standard opening signature of the "Thus Said" collection (*Itivuttaka*), emphasizing that the following text was directly spoken by the Buddha and verified by the Arahants.
2. **Craving as the Companion (*Taṇhādutiyo*):** The term *taṇhādutiyo* literally means "having craving as one's second" or "companion." As long as craving accompanies the mind, one cannot escape the cycle of samsara.
3. **The Fetter (*Saṃyojana*):** While there are ten fetters in Buddhist doctrine, this sutta highlights craving as the single most critical and binding fetter that drives the wheel of suffering.